WHY ISLAM?

Session 1: Questioning Axioms & The Natural State of Belief

Presenter: Muhammad Ahmed Khan

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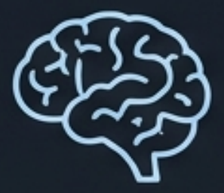
Establishing Objective Criteria for Reality



Logic & Reason

Evaluating foundational claims without circular reasoning or blind cultural inheritance.

فِطْرَة

Innate Intuition (*Fitrah*)

Aligning our worldview with human internal design and psychological hardwiring.

Objective Evidence

Testing historical, literary, and cosmological facts against empirical data.

We do not demand blind belief. Islam invites critical thought, objective testing, and internal consistency.

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Dragging Baseline Assumptions Into the Light

Axiom:
A foundational principle or belief taken for granted without prior proof. The bedrock upon which a worldview is built.

Objective:
To intentionally question our most basic religious axiom—Why believe in God at all?—and see which worldview stands firm under scrutiny.

The Paradigm Shift

Blind Inheritance	vs.	Conscious Conviction
Cultural Tradition	vs.	Rational Certainty
Muslim by Chance	vs.	Muslim by Choice

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The Core Question: Is God a Human Invention?

> Belief in God is a human invention, passed down entirely through societal conditioning and cultural indoctrination.

Belief in an Intelligent Creator is the default cognitive setting of the human mind.

Atheism, not belief, is the acquired cognitive position—it requires a conscious cognitive deletion.

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Cognitive Psychology Confirms Our Hardwiring

Dr. Olivera Petrovich — Oxford University

Pre-schoolers are 7x more likely to attribute the natural world to God than to humans.

Finding: Belief in God is natural; atheism is an acquired cognitive position.

Dr. Justin Barrett — Oxford University

Children are born believers in God... If a group of children grew up on an isolated island without parents, they would naturally believe in a Creator.

Finding: The internal compass operates independently of cultural indoctrination.

Prof. Paul Bloom — Yale University

Mind-body dualism and the inherent belief in a divine designer are hardwired into human psychology from early childhood.

Finding: We do not arrive as a blank slate.

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A Psychological Truth Mapped 1,400 Years Ago

- **The Definition:**
  The uncorrupted state in which Allah created human beings, pre-programmed with divine awareness and an affinity to worship the One Creator.
- **The Blueprint:**
  You do not arrive in this world as a ‘blank slate’.
- **The Golden Compass:**
  You do not need to be taught that God exists; you are born with the compass pointing to Him already installed.

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Revelation Echoing Human Nature

"So direct your face toward the religion, inclining to truth. [Adhere to] the fitrah of Allah upon which He has created [all] people. No change should there be in the creation of Allah..."

(Surah ar-Rum 30:30)

Allah created mankind on the Fitrah, which inherently includes knowing Him and affirming His Oneness.

— Classical Commentary (Ibn Kathir)

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Prophetic Guidance on the Default Human State

« كُلُّ مَوْلُودٍ يُولَدُ عَلَى الْفِطْرَةِ، فَأَبَوَاهُ يُهَوِّدَانِهِ أَوْ يُنَصِّرَانِهِ أَوْ يُمَجِّسَانِهِ »

Every child is born upon the Fitrah (natural state), and then his parents turn him into a Jew, a Christian, or a Magian.

— *Sahih* al-Bukhari

Notice the precision: The Prophet (ﷺ) did not say parents convert children TO the Fitrah. The environment alters the internal compass; it does not invent it. True belief is a reversion to factory settings.

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The Residue of a Primordial Conversation

> And [remember] when your Lord brought forth from the children of Adam... their descendants and made them testify over themselves, [saying]: ‘Am I not your Lord?’ They said: ‘Yes, we testify!’...
>
> (Surah al-A’raf 7:172)

The Exam Hall Metaphor

1. The Oath:
Before earthly existence, every human soul affirmed God’s Sovereignty.

2. The Veiling:
When you enter an exam hall, you leave the textbook at the door. Specific memories of this oath were veiled to allow for the genuine test of life.

3. The Residue:
While the specific memory is removed, its residue remains as the Fitrah—a lingering, indestructible recognition of our Creator.

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Un-Clouding the Mirror of the Soul

Why do people reject God if belief is natural?

The Clouding Factors (Dust):
External conditioning, societal pressures, trauma, arrogance, and cultural biases obscure the baseline.

The Pure Mirror (Fitrah):
Innate, effortless awareness of God.

Ibn Taymiyyah's Principle:
When the natural state gets clouded by external influences, a person requires rational arguments to re-awaken their innate baseline.

The Role of Prophets:
Prophets (like Noah, Hud, and Salih) were not sent to debate abstract philosophy. They came to wipe away the dust and recall people to what they already innately knew.

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What Happens When Ideological Pressure Breaks?

"And when they board a ship, they supplicate Allah, sincere to Him in religion. But when He delivers them safely to land, at once they associate others with Him."

(Surah al-'Ankabut 29:65)

The Modern Evidence: Communist Russia

- **For 70 years**, the Soviet Union ruthlessly suppressed religion, enforcing state atheism and destroying places of worship.
- **The Rebound:** Following the USSR's collapse, Russian adults identifying as Orthodox Christian soared from **31%** (1991) to **72%** (2008)

Takeaway: You can suppress the Fitrah with ideology, but like a compressed spring, human nature forcefully defaults back to God the moment pressure is released.

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The Architectural Pillars of Unshakable Faith

True certainty (Yaqeen) occurs when your internal nature, your intellectual faculties, and your personal experiences align in perfect sync.

The Naturalistic
(Fitrah)

Internal intuition, psychological hardwiring, and the primordial oath.

(Session 1)

The Evidential
(Reason & Science)

Cosmological order, intelligent design, and textual preservation.

(Upcoming)

The Experiential
(Personal Connection)

Answered prayers, personal peace, and lived faith.

(Upcoming)

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Distilling the Fitrah & Looking Ahead

Session 1 Synthesis

- **Wired for Belief:** Science and psychology confirm atheism is an acquired position; belief is universal and untaught.
- **The Inner Compass:** Islam identified this baseline as the **Fitrah** 1,400 years ago.
- **The Dust:** External influences cloud our natural disposition, and the role of revelation is to wipe the mirror clean.

Session 2: The Cosmological Argument

Did the Universe have a beginning, and what caused it? If God created the universe, who created God?

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Does belief in God feel intuitive to you, or have intellectual doubts clouded the mirror?

Remember Prophet Ibrahim (AS): He asked God to show him how He resurrects the dead—not out of doubt, but to increase his heart's certainty. Your questions are the tools to uncloud the compass.

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